Integrated Postal Architecture
Indigo3 Money Order Management

Precision Postal Software Design

Indigo3

The Money Order Management module of the Integrated Postal Architecture (IPA) is known by the product name of *INDIGO3* and is designated by the use of the *INDIGO3* logo. The *INDIGO3* module of the Integrated Postal Architecture will manage the movement of domestic money orders both in paper form and electronically.

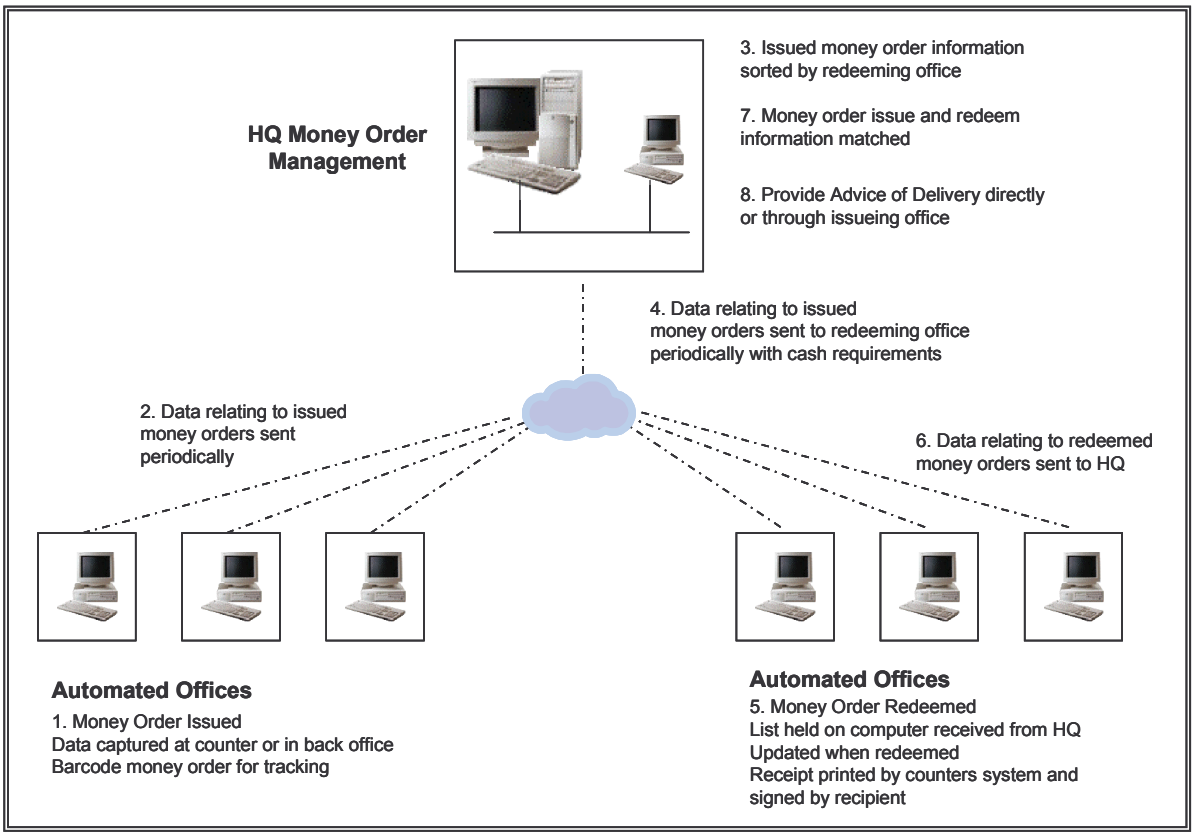
The *INDIGO3* system will replace standard money orders, express money orders, fax money orders and telegraphic money orders. The speed of the service offered being totally dependent upon the wide-area network implemented by the Post.

Controlled Process Evolution

With the possible high volumes of money order transactions it may not be practical to change the processes from the current manual procedures to a completely electronic process overnight.

For this reason the IPA Money Order system is designed such that the familiar processes can initially be retained, albeit with many improved controls and better management. This can be followed by a move to a totally automated electronic money order system as and when the majority of the post offices are suitably automated. This offers an evolution towards the use of an electronic money order system.

The transition from the current manual systems to a totally electronic money order process can be taken in a timescale agreed with the Post.



Information Flow

The diagram shows the flow of information relating to domestic money orders. A money order will be issued at the counter of a post office. If the post office is automated with the *CORVUS* branch automation system, the money order is issued by *CORVUS* and the information passed seamlessly to the *INDIGO3* money order management system. If however *CORVUS* is not implemented in the post office, an *INDIGO3* workstation will be used to capture the information relating to the issued money order.

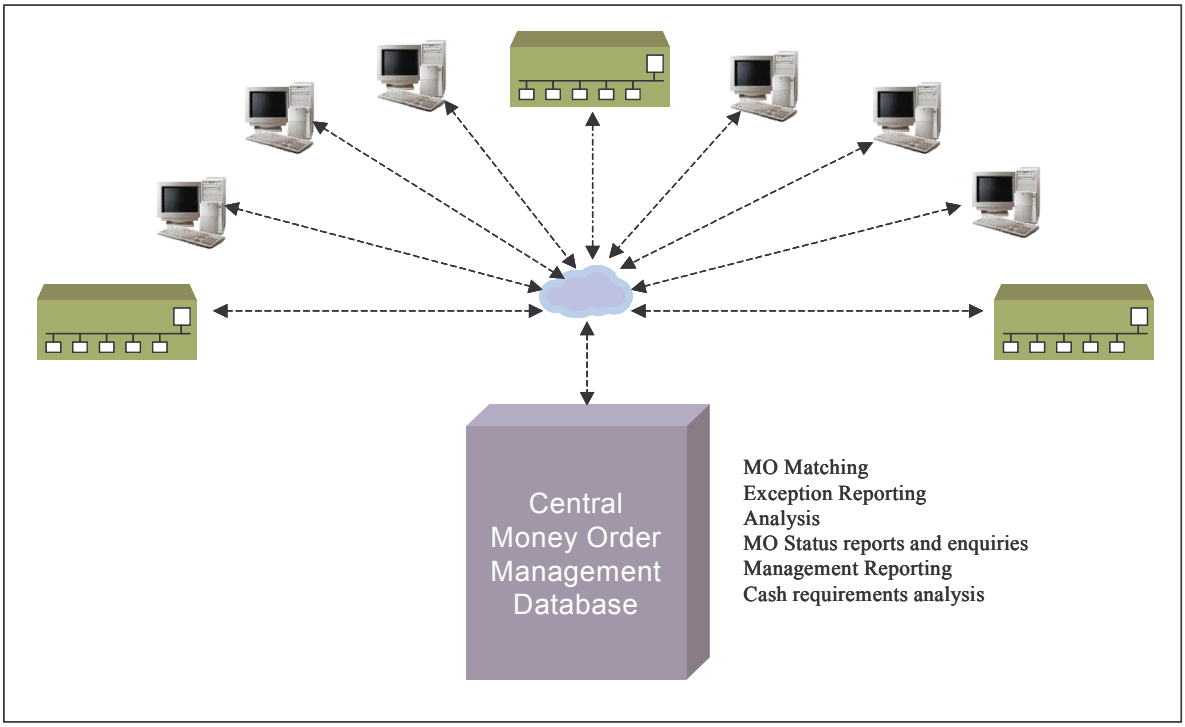
The flow of information from issuing office to redeeming office will depend upon the communications network being used. A Post may wish to discard the paper money order from the start and promote a completely electronic money order service, thus the Post will be able to offer a high-speed money transfer service to its customers.

INDIGO3 or *CORVUS*

The issue and redeem transactions can be conducted through the *CORVUS* branch automation system or directly through an *INDIGO3* workstation. In an automated office the transactions captured by *CORVUS* are routed to the central money order management system and are also captured on the office cash account along with all other services conducted in the branch.

International Money Orders

INDIGO3 has the facility to process both domestic and international money orders with other Posts using the *INDIGO3* system. Clearly, bi-lateral agreements will be required between the Posts to agree the service levels and product positioning.



Leaving the Paper Behind

With the network of post offices automated in some way, either with full counter automation or with *INDIGO3* workstations only, it is possible now to conduct the money order transaction electronically and leave the paper either at the issuing post office or sent to headquarters.

With the possible introduction of modern communication options, we have the possibility to offer a real-time electronic money order service.

There are certain considerations and process changes necessary if the money order service is to operate in this way. For example, with the process discussed previously, it was possible for the central money order management system to pre-warn the redeeming post office of the cash requirements necessary in order to meet the demands of pending money order redemptions. Clearly, if we are able to issue money orders in one post office and redeem them in another post office within a few hours, then the cash holding and management must be reviewed in order to meet the possible unexpected demand for cash.

Benefits of *INDIGO3* solution

- ⇒ Ability to track the status of any issued money order by an immediate computer enquiry
- ⇒ Potential for high speed premium money order service (with higher fees) depending upon the countrywide network
- ⇒ Prevention of duplicate payments of money orders thus preventing fraud
- ⇒ Dramatically reduces the amount of paper documents in use
- ⇒ Automatic production of reports and journals saves clerk and supervisor time
- ⇒ Management reports available from the central system of MOs paid and unpaid, analysed by region or by post office, or by clerk if necessary
- ⇒ Integration with Corvus offers integrated countrywide service

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Cost-effective / Flexible / Integrated

Precision Postal Software Design